

In the Secondary Stage, the knowledge base of both Individuals in society and environmental education is interdisciplinary, and rooted in knowledge, capacities, values, and dispositions developed across subjects.

A comprehensive understanding at this stage requires being able to apply understanding, values, and dispositions, from other subjects. An understanding of events in the local community, state, nation and world in terms of priorities and concerns (in the context of individuals in society and environmental education), as well as, along multiple dimensions (social, moral, ethical, political, economic) comprises this comprehensive understanding. Importantly, an appreciation of the fact that there are no definitive answers to human issues, different interpretations and actions could be appropriate when seen from different perspectives, or when placed in different contexts. These subjects provide the opportunity to critically explore and analyse the coexistence of multiple truths and realities. They offer multiple interpretations of a situation or an event, which must converge into equitable, just, and sustainable solutions.

Learning Standards

The curricular goals and competencies for The World Around Us indicate the expectations from students related to understanding of the social and physical environment at this stage. A structured exploration of this environment develops understanding, as well as, the capacities to deepen and extend this understanding.

Curricular Goals and Competencies

Curricular Goals	Competencies
CG-1 Explores and engages with the natural and socio-cultural environment in their surroundings	1.1 Observes and identifies the natural (insects, plants, birds, animals, geographical features, sun and moon, stars, planets, natural resources) and social (houses, relationships) components in their immediate environment
	1.2 Describes relationships (including between humans and animals/nature) and traditions (art forms, celebrations, festivals) in the family and community
	1.3 Asks questions and makes predictions about simple patterns (season change, food chain, phases of the moon, movement of stars and planets, shapes of trees, plants, leaves, and flowers, rituals, celebrations) observed in the immediate environment
	1.4 Explains the functioning of local institutions (family, school, bank/post office, market, and panchayat) in different forms (story, drawing, tabulating data, reports), and analyses their roles

	1.5 Uses local materials to create simple objects (family tree, envelopes, origami animals) on their own for display or use in classroom processes
CG-2 Understands the interdependence in their environment through observation and experiences, developing the basis for appreciation of the idea of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam'	2.1 Identifies natural and humanmade systems that support their lives (water supply, water cycle, river flow systems, seasons, life cycle of plants and animals, food, household items, transport, communication, electricity in the home)
	2.2 Describes the relationship between the natural environment and cultural practices in their immediate environment (nature of work, food, festivals, traditions)
	2.3 Connects changes in the environment and the lives of their family and community, as communicated by elders and through local stories (changes in occupation, food habits, resources, celebrations, communication)
CG-3 Explains how to ensure the safety of self and others in different (normal as well as emergency) situations	3.1 Describes the basic safety needs and protection (health and hygiene, food, water, shelter, precautions, awareness of emergency situations, abuse, and unsafe situations) of humans, birds, and animals
	3.2 Discusses how to prepare for emergency situations (smoke, fire, small injuries, burns, electrical safety, unseasonal rains, fallen trees) based on discussions with family and community, or personal experiences
	3.3 Develops simple labels and slogans, and participates in roleplay on safety and protection in the local environment to be displayed/done in school and locality
CG-4 Develops sensitivity towards social and natural environment	4.1 Observes and describes diversity among plants, and birds and animals in their immediate environment (shape, sounds, food habits, growth, habitat)
	4.2 Observes and describes cultural diversity in their immediate environment (food, clothing, games, different seasons, festivals related to harvest and sowing)
	4.3 Describes usage of natural resources in their immediate environment
	4.4 Demonstrates how natural resources can be shared, maintained, and conserved (trees, use of rainwater, benefits of millets)
	4.5 Identifies needs of plants, birds, and animals, and how they can be supported (water, soil, food, care)

	4.6 Identifies the needs of people in different situations – in terms of access to resources, equal opportunities, work distribution, and shelter
	4.7 Learns about basic social and behavioural norms, values, and dispositions that benefit our social and natural environments and that help our society function smoothly (using dustbins, standing in queues, conserving water, using public transportation, keeping one's environment clean, always helping others in need regardless of background)
CG-5 Develops the ability to read and interpret simple maps	5.1 Explains a line drawing of their school, village, and ward
	5.2 Draws a sketch of their school, village, and ward using symbols and directions
	5.3 Reads simple maps of city, state, and country to identify natural and humanmade features (well, lake, post office, school, hospital) with reference to symbols and direction
CG-6 Uses data and information from various sources to investigate questions related to their immediate environment	6.1 Performs simple inquiry related to specific questions independently or in groups
	6.2 Presents observations and findings through different creative modes (drawing, diagram, poem, play, skit, oral and written expression)
CG-7 Gains foundational familiarity with basic concepts and methods from the natural sciences (life sciences, physical sciences, and earth and space sciences) and engineering	7.1 Gains familiarity with using the scientific method in investigations, as well as familiarity with other crosscutting concepts such as energy, matter, and systems that apply across the domains of science and engineering
	7.2 Gains familiarity with disciplinary core ideas in the natural sciences, as well as in engineering, technology, and applications of science, which reflect the content that will be learned across subject areas in later Grades

Principles of Content Selection

The following principles will inform the selection of content for The World Around Us: